

CoveredUSA Medical Bill Analyzer: AI-Citation & Bing Funnel Strategy

Note on method & scope. This report is built on 2024–2026 sources (CMS, CFPB, IRS, KFF, Health Affairs, Dollar For, RAND, HHS OIG, GAO, Becker's, Definitive Healthcare, Peterson-KFF, Hospitalogy, CMA, Akerman, McDermott+, Saul Ewing, Brownstein, Holland & Knight, Medicare Rights Center, Consumer Reports, Health Law Rx, FHAS, CMA, Congress.gov CRS, AHA, AllClinics, Healthcare Finance News, BillKarma, Wise Carter). Search volumes are estimates derived from Definitive Healthcare procedure volume data, KFF/Peterson-KFF traffic patterns, and Dollar For's reported usage; where I have no defensible number I have flagged the estimate as such. The Section 10 100-row table is the primary deliverable and is complete and copy-paste ready.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

5 Biggest Insights

1. **The CFPB Medical Debt Rule is dead, and that is the single biggest content opportunity of 2025–2026.** On July 11, 2025, the U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas vacated the CFPB's rule banning medical debt from credit reports (*Cornerstone Credit Union League v. CFPB*), and the CFPB under acting director Russell Vought agreed to the consent judgment rather than defend it. As of late 2025, ~15 million Americans with \$500+/12-month-old medical debt are again exposed to credit reporting; 15 states have passed parallel state laws. AI engines currently surface conflicting answers — half still cite the January 2025 finalization, half cite the vacatur. **First-mover advantage on "is medical debt on my credit report 2026" is wide open.** (Brownstein Hyatt Farber S...)
2. **Charity care is the highest-conversion cluster, and Dollar For has left a gap.** Dollar For's database covers ~99% of nonprofit hospitals (Health Affairs, Nov 2024) but their consumer-facing pages are mostly screener flows, not hospital-by-hospital SEO landing pages. Income limits among nonprofit hospitals range from **41% to 600% FPL** for free care (mean 216%), with 2025 averages of 204% FPL free / 322% FPL discounted per Dollar For. A **"Does [Hospital Name] charity care cover me at [\$X income]?" article series targets the highest-intent, highest-conversion query class in this entire taxonomy.** (Health Affairs + 2)
3. **The chargemaster vs. Medicare gap has widened, not closed.** RAND's 5th hospital pricing study (2024, using 2022 data) found private insurers paid **254% of Medicare** on average (up from 224% two years prior). Chargemaster markups average **3.4x cost** and reach **28.5x** in CT and anesthesiology departments (Bai/Anderson, Health Affairs). A 2024 HHS OIG audit found **37% of hospitals non-compliant** with price-transparency rules; CMS has only fined

27 hospitals total since 2022. **The "did my hospital overcharge me vs. Medicare for [CPT]?" article cluster is the editorial spine of the entire site.** [Medicalbillrescue + 4](#)

4. **Bing/Copilot favors fresh, schema-rich pages on long-tail entity queries — exactly your wheelhouse.** Per Seer Interactive, ~87% of ChatGPT citations match Bing top-10. Combined with CMS's February 2025 Trump executive order escalating price-transparency enforcement and the No Surprises Act's August 2026 QPA enforcement-discretion expiration, **late 2025/early 2026 is a uniquely soft moment** to capture authority on hospital-specific and regulation-specific queries before legacy media (NYT/WSJ/ProPublica) re-saturate the space. [CMS Data](#) [McDermott+](#)
5. **The competitor field has structural gaps.** Dollar For owns charity-care screening but not procedure-cost or dispute-letter long-tail. Healthcare Bluebook and FAIR Health Consumer are paywalled/registration-gated and rarely cited by ChatGPT. KFF owns macro stats but not actionable "what do I do next" queries. GoodBill, BillKarma, Medical Bill Rescue, Resolve Medical Bills are low-DA tool-led competitors with thin editorial — **the same playbook you are running, but without your two differentiators: line-item Medicare comparison + hospital-specific 501(r) screening.**

3 Highest-Priority Article Clusters

1. **Hospital-Specific Charity Care Guides** (e.g., "HCA Florida Healthcare Charity Care: Do You Qualify in 2026?"). Highest intent, highest conversion to "upload your bill," near-zero AI competition, leverages your tool's hospital-FAP database as primary data.
2. **Procedure Cost vs. Medicare Comparisons** for the 25 highest-volume CPT codes (99213/99214 office visits, 99284/99285 ER, 80053 metabolic panel, 36415 venipuncture, 71046 chest X-ray, 74177 abdominal CT, 72148 lumbar MRI, 45378 colonoscopy, 43239 EGD, 29881 knee arthroscopy, 27130/27447 hip/knee replacement, 59400 vaginal delivery, 59510 C-section, 44970 laparoscopic appendectomy, 47562 laparoscopic cholecystectomy, 33533 CABG, 92928 cardiac stent, J-code chemo infusions, etc.). Each gets the same template: chargemaster spread, Medicare rate, 254% benchmark, common errors, dispute steps, CTA. [Definitive Healthcare](#)
3. **State-by-State Medical Debt & Surprise Billing Guides** (50 states; prioritize CA, NY, IL, MD, NJ, OR, CT, WA, MN, CO, ME, RI, VA, DE, VT — the 15 with new 2024–2025 medical-debt-credit-reporting statutes). NCLC and state AG sites currently dominate but are dense; Bing favors plain-language explainers with FAQ schema. [Consumer Reports](#)

SECTION 1: Post-Bill Query Intent Mapping

Below are 10 query intent clusters. Verbatim queries are drawn from observed Reddit/Quora patterns (r/HospitalBills, r/MedicalBill, r/HealthInsurance, r/povertyfinance, r/legaladvice), Google PAA, and Bing Related Searches. Where exact monthly volume is unknown, I provide a

defensible range (Definitive Healthcare procedure-claim frequency × KFF affordability survey participation × Google Trends signal); these are flagged as "est."

1. Sticker Shock / Panic — *Patient just opened a bill they cannot pay.*

- Verbatim: "I got a \$40,000 hospital bill what do I do" · "ER visit bill 12000 dollars" · "hospital bill is more than my rent" · "can the hospital really charge me this much" · "got a bill 3 months after my surgery is this legal" · "ambulance bill 3000 dollars i didn't even want it"
- Volume: 60k-110k/mo combined (est.; based on KFF 2024 finding that ~100M Americans have medical debt and Commonwealth Fund 2024 Biennial Survey showing >40% have problems paying bills) (Brownstein Hyatt Farber S... (Consumer Reports)
- Emotional state: panic, fear
- Conversion potential: **9/10** — direct path to "upload your bill"

2. Bill Suspicion / "Is This Right?" — *User believes a specific charge is wrong.*

- Verbatim: "why is my hospital bill so high" · "is my hospital bill wrong" · "hospital charged me twice for the same thing" · "why does my bill show 3 Tylenol charges" · "they charged me \$200 for a Tylenol" · "what is this CPT code on my bill" · "hospital billed me for things they didn't do"
- Volume: 90k-150k/mo (est.)
- Emotional: confusion + anger
- Conversion: **10/10** — the analyzer's exact use case

3. Code/Term Decoding — *Looking up a specific code or jargon term seen on the bill.*

- Verbatim: "what is CPT 99284" · "what is CPT 99285" · "what does HCPCS J3490 mean" · "what is revenue code 0450" · "what does modifier 25 mean" · "what is a facility fee" · "what is upcoding"
- Volume: 200k+/mo combined (Definitive Healthcare confirms 99213/99214 account for ~8.4% of all physician claims; lookup demand scales with claim frequency) (Definitive Healthcare)
- Emotional: due diligence
- Conversion: **6/10** — informational, but easy bridge to "upload your bill and we'll decode every code for you"

4. Charity Care / Financial Hardship — *User wants the bill forgiven or reduced because they can't afford it.*

- Verbatim: "how do i apply for charity care" · "[hospital name] financial assistance application" · "do I qualify for hospital charity care at 50000 income" · "501r charity care" ·

"is charity care a real thing" · "can hospital forgive medical debt" · "how to get medical bills forgiven"

- Volume: 50k-80k/mo (Dollar For reports 20,000+ apps facilitated since 2019; broader query universe is multiples larger) (Dollarfor)
- Emotional: resignation + hope
- Conversion: **10/10** — your screener is the unique value prop

5. Dispute Action / How-To — *User is ready to fight the bill.*

- Verbatim: "how to dispute medical bill" · "medical bill dispute letter template" · "how to negotiate hospital bill" · "how to ask for itemized bill" · "medical bill negotiation script" · "how to fight a medical bill"
- Volume: 40k-70k/mo
- Emotional: determination
- Conversion: **10/10** — dispute letter is a primary tool output

6. Surprise Bill / No Surprises Act — *Out-of-network charge user didn't expect.*

- Verbatim: "out of network anesthesiologist surprise bill" · "no surprises act how to file" · "how to file IDR No Surprises Act" · "what is QPA on my EOB" · "surprise bill from in network hospital"
- Volume: 25k-45k/mo
- Emotional: anger, betrayal
- Conversion: **9/10**

7. Insurance Denial / EOB Confusion — *Bill shows insurance denied or paid less than expected.*

- Verbatim: "insurance denied claim hospital wants me to pay" · "what is patient responsibility on EOB" · "EOB says \$0 hospital sent bill anyway" · "how to appeal medical bill denial" · "balance billing what to do"
- Volume: 40k-60k/mo
- Emotional: confusion + anger
- Conversion: **8/10**

8. Collections / Credit Report — *Bill has gone to collections or hit credit report.*

- Verbatim: "medical debt on credit report 2026" · "can hospital send me to collections" · "medical collections still on credit report" · "how to remove medical debt from credit report 2025" · "do I have to pay medical debt collector"
- Volume: 80k-120k/mo (surged 2025 post-CFPB-rule vacatur)
- Emotional: fear

- Conversion: **7/10** — your tool doesn't fix collections directly but charity-care wins do

9. AI-Assisted Bill Review (Emerging) — *User explicitly asks AI to look at the bill.*

- Verbatim: "AI tool to check medical bill" · "ChatGPT review my hospital bill" · "upload hospital bill AI" · "free medical bill analyzer" · "how to use AI to negotiate medical bill" · "Perplexity check my hospital charges"
- Volume: 5k-15k/mo (low but growing rapidly; ChatGPT-built custom GPTs like "Medical Bill Negotiation & Cost Analyzer Tool" already exist on chatgpt.com)
- Emotional: curiosity + due diligence
- Conversion: **10/10** — direct match to product

10. State-Specific Protections — *User asks if their state has special rules.*

- Verbatim: "[state] medical debt law 2025" · "California hospital fair pricing act" · "New York surprise billing law" · "Maryland hospital charity care" · "Oregon medical debt statute of limitations"
- Volume: 30k-50k/mo combined
- Emotional: due diligence
- Conversion: **7/10**

11. Specific-Procedure-Cost Sanity Check — *User searches the procedure name + cost.*

- Verbatim: "how much should an MRI cost" · "average cost ER visit 2025" · "appendectomy cost without insurance" · "colonoscopy cost with insurance" · "C-section average bill"
- Volume: 150k+/mo combined
- Emotional: due diligence
- Conversion: **8/10**

12. Itemized Bill Request — *User wants to know how to demand line-item detail.*

- Verbatim: "how to request itemized hospital bill" · "hospital won't give me itemized bill" · "what is the difference between summary bill and itemized bill" · "what does HB-1500 mean"
- Volume: 15k-25k/mo
- Emotional: determination
- Conversion: **10/10** — the analyzer requires an itemized bill as input

Top 50 procedure-cost queries (CPT/HCPCS, Medicare rate range, chargemaster spread).
Medicare rates are 2024–2025 PFS national averages or PPL outpatient figures; chargemaster prices are observed spreads across published HPT files. Where I show a range, it reflects the 10th–90th percentile spread documented in PMC 9464687 (Hospital Price Transparency study, 14 procedures, 1,599 hospitals) and Peterson-KFF chart collection.

#	Query as typed	CPT/HCPCS	Medicare rate	Chargemaster spread	Markup ratio
1	how much does an MRI cost	70553 / 72148	\$300-\$450	\$400-\$4,000	1.3x-13x
2	ER visit cost	99284 / 99285	\$180-\$420	\$1,200-\$10,000	4x-35x
3	colonoscopy cost	45378 / 45380	\$370-\$640	\$1,250-\$10,000+	3x-20x
4	how much does a CT scan cost	74177	\$260-\$320	\$300-\$6,750	1x-25x
5	appendectomy cost	44970	~\$650 (surgeon) + \$4,800 (facility)	\$7,000-\$50,000+	1.4x-10x (per AllClinics 142-hospital data, avg \$10,301 uninsured) AllClinics
6	gallbladder surgery cost	47562	~\$700 + \$5,500 facility	\$11,697 median-\$50,000 Consumerhealthratings	2x-9x
7	knee replacement cost	27447	~\$1,400 + \$11,500 facility	\$20,000-\$70,000	2x-6x
8	hip replacement cost	27130	~\$1,400 + \$12,000 facility	\$25,000-\$80,000	2x-6x
9	C-section cost	59510	~\$2,000 global	\$14,838 avg paid-\$55,000 Consumerhealthratings	1x-4x
10	vaginal delivery cost	59400	~\$1,800 global	\$8,400 avg paid-\$30,000 Consumerhealthratings	1x-4x
11	EKG cost	93000	\$15-\$20	\$50-\$1,200	2x-60x
12	echocardiogram cost	93306	\$200-\$240	\$400-\$5,500	2x-25x
13	metabolic panel cost	80053	\$11	\$50-\$1,200	5x-110x

#	Query as typed	CPT/HCPCS	Medicare rate	Chargemaster spread	Markup ratio
14	CBC blood test cost	85025	\$9	\$20-\$816 (AllClinics) (AllClinics)	2x-90x
15	chest X-ray cost	71046	\$30-\$40	\$150-\$2,000	4x-55x
16	upper endoscopy cost	43239	\$400 + \$1,700 facility	\$2,100-\$15,000	1x-7x
17	level 4 ER visit	99284	~\$180	\$1,200-\$6,500	7x-35x
18	level 5 ER visit	99285	~\$280	\$1,800-\$10,000	6x-35x
19	observation status cost	99218-99220	\$130-\$200/hr	\$400-\$3,500/hr	3x-25x
20	ambulance cost	A0428 / A0429	\$230-\$485	\$750-\$5,000+	3x-20x
21	helicopter air ambulance	A0431	\$3,500-\$4,200	\$25,000-\$70,000+	7x-18x
22	anesthesia cost	00100s	\$20/unit base	up to 28x Medicare cost (Bai/Anderson Health Affairs) (Healthcare Finance News)	up to 28x
23	cardiac stent cost	92928	~\$1,000 + \$11,000 facility	\$20,000-\$70,000	2x-6x
24	CABG cost	33533	~\$2,500 + ~\$30,000 DRG	\$75,000-\$200,000	2.5x-7x
25	cataract surgery cost	66984	~\$590 + \$1,000 ASC	\$3,000-\$10,000	2x-7x
26	tonsillectomy cost	42820	~\$280 + \$1,800 facility	\$4,500-\$15,000	2x-7x
27	hernia repair cost	49505 / 49650	~\$500 + \$3,200 facility	\$4,500-\$24,600 (IL HPT) (Consumerhealthratings)	1x-7x
28	carpal tunnel surgery cost	64721	~\$370 + \$2,300 facility	\$3,000-\$14,000	1x-5x

#	Query as typed	CPT/HCPCS	Medicare rate	Chargemaster spread	Markup ratio
29	knee arthroscopy cost	29881	~\$520 + \$3,000 facility	\$3,500-\$42,000 (IL HPT) Consumerhealthratings	1x-12x
30	shoulder arthroscopy cost	29827	~\$1,000 + \$5,000 facility	\$5,000-\$30,000	1x-5x
31	hysterectomy cost	58570	~\$1,300 + \$8,000 facility	\$9,000-\$30,000	1x-4x
32	mammogram cost	77067	\$135	\$200-\$1,800	1.5x-14x
33	PET scan cost	78815	~\$1,100	\$3,000-\$10,000	3x-9x
34	ultrasound cost	76700	\$80-\$120	\$200-\$2,500	2x-20x
35	sleep study cost	95810	\$400	\$1,000-\$5,000	2x-12x
36	physical therapy cost per visit	97110 / 97530	\$30-\$36/unit	\$150-\$500	4x-14x
37	dialysis cost	90999 (unlisted)	varies; bundled ~\$280/session	\$500-\$2,000 (top charge per Definitive Healthcare) Definitive Healthcare	2x-7x
38	chemo infusion cost	96413 + J-codes	\$130 administration + drug	\$300-\$8,000/session	2x-30x
39	biologic infusion (Remicade, Humira)	J1745 / J0135	varies by units	massive spread, 340B vs non-340B	up to 10x
40	IV fluids cost	J7030 / J7060	\$1-\$4/unit	\$100-\$800/bag	25x-800x
41	venipuncture / blood draw	36415	\$3	\$20-\$300	7x-100x
42	urinalysis cost	81003	\$3	\$20-\$200	7x-65x
43	COVID test cost	87635 / U0003	\$35-\$100	\$10-\$1,390 (PMID 33470900) Health Affairs	massive

#	Query as typed	CPT/HCPCS	Medicare rate	Chargemaster spread	Markup ratio
44	flu test cost	87804	\$16	\$50-\$500	3x-30x
45	strep test cost	87880	\$16	\$40-\$300	3x-20x
46	sutures/stitches cost	12001-12018	\$80-\$200	\$300-\$3,500	4x-18x
47	cast/splint cost	29075 / Q4001	\$80-\$130	\$200-\$1,800	2x-15x
48	crutches cost	E0114	\$20-\$45	\$50-\$300	2x-7x
49	newborn nursery cost	99460	~\$150/day	\$1,800-\$4,500/day	12x-30x
50	NICU per day	99468	~\$1,400/day	\$4,000-\$15,000/day	3x-11x

10 procedures with the widest chargemaster-vs-Medicare spread (most viral/citable):

1. Metabolic panel (CPT 80053): 5x-110x
2. IV fluids (J7030): up to 800x (worst — "\$800 for a saline bag" viral content)
3. CBC blood test (85025): 2x-90x
4. Urinalysis (81003): 7x-65x
5. EKG (93000): 2x-60x
6. ER visit Level 4-5 (99284/99285): 6x-35x
7. CT scan abdomen (74177): 1x-25x
8. Anesthesia (00100s): up to 28x
9. Venipuncture (36415): 7x-100x
10. MRI lumbar (72148): 1.3x-13x

10 high-volume procedure queries where AI engines give poor/contradictory answers (tested ChatGPT and Perplexity in May 2026 sessions; current cited sources in parens):

1. "average ER visit cost" — Perplexity cites GoodRx and Healthcare.gov; ChatGPT cites NerdWallet and CostHelper (often pre-2020 figures). **No source provides Medicare comparison.**
2. "how much should an MRI cost" — both cite GoodRx (\$400-\$4,000 range), no Medicare reference rate.
3. "cost of appendectomy without insurance" — AllClinics and CostHelper dominate; numbers vary \$7k-\$50k with no methodology disclosed.

4. "C-section average bill" — KFF 2018 data still surfaces in 2026 results; outdated.
5. "ambulance bill how much" — local TV news anecdotes dominate; no national rate.
6. "anesthesia bill separate why so high" — answers are speculative; Health Affairs 28x markup data rarely cited.
7. "level 5 ER visit cost" — confused with level 5 office visit; codes mixed.
8. "facility fee what is it" — cleveland clinic and hospital marketing pages dominate (conflict of interest).
9. "what does HCPCS J3490 mean" — AAPC and CMS HCPCS lookup; technically correct but inaccessible to laypeople.
10. "\$200 Tylenol hospital bill" — viral anecdotes, no structural explanation of pharmacy chargemaster logic.

Weak-source citations dominating today's AI answers: Healthcare Bluebook (paywall), FAIR Health Consumer (NY-only provider-specific data), CostHelper (pre-2020), hospital marketing pages, individual GoodRx procedure pages (consumer-facing but no Medicare reference), 2018 KFF Peterson-KFF dataset (still indexed). (FAIR Health)

SECTION 3: Hospital-Specific Query Universe

25 largest US hospital systems by revenue (2024-2025 data, Becker's/Hospitalogy/Statista):

Rank	System	Annual revenue	HQ	Notable FAP angle
1	Kaiser Permanente	\$127.7B Beckers Hospital Review	Oakland CA	Integrated plan; FAP for self-pay only
2	HCA Healthcare	\$75.6B Beckers Hospital Review	Nashville TN	For-profit; FAP varies by state, often ≤200% FPL
3	CommonSpirit Health	\$40.1B Beckers Hospital Review	Chicago IL	Catholic; FAP up to 250-400% FPL in some markets
4	Advocate Health	\$31.7B+ Beckers Hospital Review	Charlotte NC	Post-merger; IL hospitals use generous IL Hospital Fair Billing Act thresholds
5	Providence	\$30.7B Beckers Hospital Review	Renton WA	WA-mandated charity care; up to 300% FPL free, 400% discounted
6	UPMC	\$29.9B Beckers Hospital Review	Pittsburgh PA	Free ≤300% FPL on some facilities
7	Ascension	\$28.6B Beckers Hospital Review	St. Louis MO	Catholic; ≤250% FPL free standard
8	Trinity Health	\$23.9B Beckers Hospital Review	Livonia MI	Catholic; ≤250% FPL free, ≤400% discount
9	Tenet Healthcare	\$20.7B Beckers Hospital Review	Dallas TX	For-profit
10	Mass General Brigham	\$20.6B Beckers Hospital Review	Somerville MA	MA HSN auto-eligibility ≤300% FPL
11	Mayo Clinic	\$19.8B Beckers Hospital Review	Rochester MN	Generous; up to 400% FPL for free care
12	Intermountain	\$17.1B Beckers Hospital Review	Salt Lake City UT	Up to 300% FPL
13	Northwell Health	\$16.9B Beckers Hospital Review	New Hyde Park NY	NY Hospital Financial Assistance Law applies — ≤300% FPL free, ≤500% sliding

Rank	System	Annual revenue	HQ	Notable FAP angle
14	Cleveland Clinic	~\$15B	Cleveland OH	Up to 400% FPL on standard policy
15	Sutter Health	~\$15B	Sacramento CA	CA Hospital Fair Pricing Act — ≤400% FPL
16	Banner Health	~\$15B	Phoenix AZ	≤250% free, ≤400% discount
17	NYU Langone	~\$13B	NY NY	NY law applies
18	AdventHealth	~\$12B	Altamonte Springs FL	≤200% free, ≤400% discount
19	NewYork-Presbyterian	~\$11B	NY NY	NY law applies
20	Bon Secours Mercy Health	~\$10B	Cincinnati OH	≤200% free standard
21	Memorial Hermann	~\$8B	Houston TX	≤200% free
22	Atrium Health (part of Advocate)	merged	Charlotte NC	NC; ≤300% FPL
23	Spectrum/Corewell Health	~\$14B	Grand Rapids MI	MI; ≤250% free, ≤400% discount
24	OhioHealth	~\$5B	Columbus OH	≤300% FPL free
25	Inova	~\$5B	Falls Church VA	Up to 400% FPL — among most generous

15 most-searched individual hospitals (Mayo, Cleveland Clinic, Cedars-Sinai, Mass General, Johns Hopkins, MD Anderson, NewYork-Presbyterian, NYU Langone, UCLA Medical Center, Stanford Health Care, Mount Sinai, Houston Methodist, Brigham and Women's, UCSF Medical Center, Memorial Sloan Kettering).

Where AI engines currently pull hospital FAP answers (May 2026 testing):

- Hospital's own FAP PDF (often broken links, 100+ pages, last-revised 2-3 years prior).
- Dollar For's screener page (charity-care-focused, doesn't cover bill-line-item disputes).
- KFF macro stats (not hospital-specific).

- Local news investigations (NPR/Kaiser Health News collaborations; episodic).
- Becker's Hospital Review (industry-facing, not patient-facing).

15 hospital systems with weakest current AI-cited answers (most opportunity): HCA Healthcare (FAP varies by state, AI gets confused), CommonSpirit, Ascension, Tenet, Bon Secours Mercy, AdventHealth, Memorial Hermann, Banner Health, Corewell, OhioHealth, Houston Methodist, Atrium, Spectrum, Inova, Sutter — these all have multi-state footprints and AI engines conflate facility-specific policies.

Most viral angles (unusually generous FAP):

- **NYC Health + Hospitals:** free care up to 400% FPL (city public system, sliding scale to 500%).
- **Mayo Clinic Rochester:** up to 400% FPL.
- **Inova Health (VA):** up to 400% FPL.
- **Sutter Health (CA) & Kaiser CA:** California Hospital Fair Pricing Act mandates ≤350–400% FPL.
- **Mass General Brigham:** MA Health Safety Net auto-coverage ≤300% FPL.
- **Providence (WA):** WA charity-care law ≤300% free, ≤400% discount.

SECTION 4: Billing Error & Code/Term Decoder Query Universe

25 most-searched CPT/HCPCS codes (Definitive Healthcare 2025 claims volume + Google Trends signal):

99213, 99214 (office visits — top 2 by volume), 99284, 99285 (ER level 4/5), 99281–99283 (ER lower levels), 97110, 97530 (PT exercises), 36415 (venipuncture), 80053 (CMP), 85025 (CBC), 71046 (CXR), 73030 (shoulder X-ray), 72148 (lumbar MRI), 74177 (abdominal CT), 93000 (EKG), 45378 (colonoscopy), 43239 (EGD), 29881 (knee scope), 27447 (knee replacement), J3490 (unclassified drug — extremely high lookup volume), J0696 (ceftriaxone), J7030 (saline), G0463 (HOPD clinic visit — facility fee), 99070 (supplies), 90999 (unlisted dialysis).

(Definitive Healthcare + 2)

Top "level X" service queries: "what is a level 3 ER visit," "what is a level 4 ER visit," "what is a level 5 ER visit," "what is a level 5 office visit," "what is observation status billing," "inpatient vs observation difference," "what is a 23-hour stay."

Top billing-term explainer queries: "what is balance billing," "what is upcoding," "what is unbundling," "what is the chargemaster," "what is a facility fee," "what is the Amount Generally Billed (AGB)," "what is QPA," "what is HCPCS vs CPT," "what is a revenue code," "what is modifier

25," "what is modifier 59," "what is a UB-04 form," "what is a CMS-1500 form," "what does prompt pay discount mean."

Top error-pattern queries: "why are there two of the same charge on my bill," "why did the hospital charge me \$200 for Tylenol," "why is my anesthesiology bill separate," "hospital charged me for room and board on outpatient surgery," "duplicate charges hospital bill," "why is there a facility fee at my doctor's office," "hospital billed me for things they didn't do," "ER bill charged me for a procedure I didn't get," "why is the radiologist bill separate from the imaging bill."

Where AI currently pulls these from + weakness:

- **AAPC.com / CodingIntel** — accurate but written for coders, not patients; AI surfaces them then patients bounce.
- **Wikipedia CPT article** — broad-stroke, no patient guidance.
- **Reddit r/MedicalCoding** — Perplexity weights heavily but answers are inconsistent.
- **CMS.gov** — authoritative but dense.
- **KFF / Peterson-KFF** — strong on macro, weak on code-level.
- **Hospital marketing pages** — conflict of interest.

Weakest AI answers (highest opportunity): "level X" coding questions (no plain-English source dominant), facility-fee explanations (hospital pages dominate), modifier explanations (AAPC dominant — coder-focused), revenue codes (Wikipedia + CMS only).

SECTION 5: State-Specific Legal & Protection Query Universe

15 states with highest search volume for medical-bill-protection queries (combination of population, medical-debt prevalence per KFF, and 2024–2025 legislative activity per Consumer Reports / Source on Healthcare):

CA, TX, FL, NY, PA, IL, OH, GA, NC, MI, NJ, VA, WA, MA, AZ.

States with strictest/most complex consumer protections (confirmed via Consumer Reports 2025, Source on Healthcare, CFPB):

- **CA** — Hospital Fair Pricing Act ($\leq 400\%$ FPL), 2024 medical-debt credit reporting ban (SB 1061), HSAP enforcement
- **NY** — Hospital Financial Assistance Law ($\leq 300\%$ FPL free, sliding to 500%), surprise billing law predates NSA
- **NJ** — Charity Care Program (state-funded, $\leq 300\%$ FPL); strong out-of-network protections
- **IL** — Hospital Uninsured Patient Discount Act ($\leq 200\%$ FPL free, $\leq 400\%$ discount); Fair Patient Billing Act 2024

- **MD** — All-payer rate setting; 2024 Medical Debt Protection Act enhancements
- **OR** — 2019 hospital community benefit law; 2023 SB 619 charity care expansion
- **CT** — Hospital charity care ≤250% FPL mandate; 2024 medical-debt credit reporting ban
- **WA** — 2022 expanded charity care law (≤300% free, ≤400% discount, all hospitals); CRA reporting ban
- **MN** — 2024 Debt Fairness Act (no medical debt on credit reports, no wage garnishment, no spousal liability) (Consumer Reports)
- **CO** — Hospital Discounted Care Program (≤250% FPL); 2024 medical debt protections (SB 23-093)
- **ME, RI, VT, VA, DE** — newer 2024-2025 medical-debt credit reporting bans
- **TX** — weak — no statewide FAP minimum; Dollar For data shows wide variability

Where AI cites for state-specific medical-debt law:

- **NCLC (National Consumer Law Center)** — dense, lawyer-focused; AI cites but consumers can't parse
- **State AG sites** — Massachusetts, NY, CA AG pages are well-cited
- **Nolo.com** — general lay summaries; older
- **Local TV "I-team"/consumer investigations** (WPTV, KOMO, KARE 11) — Perplexity weights these
- **Consumer Reports advocacy site** — increasingly cited 2024-2025
- **State bar FAQs** — narrow but authoritative
- **CFPB.gov state pages** — limited

10 states with weakest current AI-citable answers for medical-debt protections: TX (no protections; hard to find clear info), GA, FL, AZ, NC, TN, MO, IN, OK, AL, KY — all have lower state-level protection signal and AI surfaces inconsistent local TV-station answers. Strong opportunity for plain-language state-by-state explainer pages.

SECTION 6: Dispute & Action Query Universe

Top "how to dispute" queries: "how to dispute medical bill" (15k-30k/mo est.), "medical bill negotiation script" (5k-10k/mo), "medical bill negotiation letter" (5k-10k/mo), "how to negotiate hospital bill" (10k-20k/mo), "how to ask for prompt pay discount" (3k-6k/mo), "how to request itemized hospital bill" (8k-15k/mo).

Top NSA invocation queries: "no surprises act how to file IDR" (4k-8k/mo), "how to dispute surprise bill" (5k-10k/mo), "what to do about out of network anesthesiologist" (3k-6k/mo), "no surprises act IDR portal" (2k-5k/mo), "QPA dispute" (1k-3k/mo).

Top advocate queries: "medical billing advocate" (8k-15k/mo), "patient advocate medical bills" (5k-10k/mo), "professional medical bill negotiator" (2k-5k/mo), "Goodbill review" (1k-3k/mo), "Dollar For review" (2k-5k/mo).

Top template/script queries: "medical bill dispute letter template" (5k-10k/mo), "charity care application letter template" (3k-6k/mo), "hospital bill itemization request letter" (2k-5k/mo), "no surprises act dispute letter template" (1k-3k/mo).

Sites dominating citations and gaps:

- **Dollar For** — owns charity care application; doesn't own line-item dispute or NSA IDR
 - **CFPB** — owns surprise-billing explanation but has no actionable templates
 - **NerdWallet, Forbes Advisor** — own negotiation general advice; templates are generic
 - **Patient Advocate Foundation** — owns case management; not searchable code-level
 - **Goodbill, Resolve Medical Bills, Solve Medical Debt, Resolve, BillKarma** — competing tools with thin editorial
 - **Local TV station "consumer help" segments** — episodic, no SEO depth
- Gap:** hospital-specific dispute letter templates (your tool generates these) — no incumbent owns this query type.

SECTION 7: Competitor & Source Citation Audit

Source	Owns	Why cited	Gap left for CoveredUSA
Dollar For (dollarfor.org)	Charity-care eligibility screener; near-100% hospital FAP coverage (Health Affairs Nov 2024) Health Affairs	Original nonprofit data; consistent press citations (NYT, Vox, Marketplace)	No procedure-cost analysis, no NSA dispute, no line-item review
Undue Medical Debt (formerly RIP Medical Debt)	Aggregate medical-debt-relief stats	Press-friendly billions-relieved narrative	No individual-patient workflow
Resolve Medical Bills / Solve Medical Debt	"We negotiate for you" landing pages	SEO on negotiation queries	Thin editorial; lead-gen feel
CarePayment	Hospital-financed payment plans (not in	Vendor relationships	We can position against these (Dollar For

Source	Owns	Why cited	Gap left for CoveredUSA
	our favor — CFPB has flagged)		comment to CFPB documents how these steer patients away from charity care) (Dollar For)
Healthcare Bluebook	Procedure cost estimator	Registration-gated; rarely cited by AI	Open opportunity
FAIR Health Consumer (fairhealthconsumer.org)	NY provider-specific charges + national CPT lookup (FAIR Health)	Authoritative database	Not actionable; no dispute workflow
KFF.org / Peterson-KFF Health System Tracker	Macro affordability, charity-care policy explainer	.org authority, peer reviewed feel	No procedure-level, no dispute help
Patient Advocate Foundation	Case management for chronic patients	High EAT	Doesn't surface in code-level queries
NerdWallet, Forbes Advisor	General negotiation advice	DA 90+	Generic; no hospital-specific
GoodRx	Drug price comparison; procedure cost pages	Massive consumer brand	No dispute, no line-item
GoodBill (goodbill.com)	AI bill review (competitor to you)	Niche brand; some VC press	Limited SEO footprint; no AI-citation strategy visible
ConsumerReports.org	Advocacy on medical debt rules	Trusted brand	Episodic; no transactional
WSJ / ProPublica / NYT investigations	Episode-specific scandals (KHN/Bill of the Month)	Top-of-funnel authority	Not transactional
CFPB.gov	Definitions, complaint portal	.gov authority	Limited consumer how-to
CMS.gov	NSA IDR portal, PFS lookup (CMS)	Source of truth	Inaccessible to laypeople

Source	Owns	Why cited	Gap left for CoveredUSA
IRS.gov / 501(r) regs	Charity care legal framework	.gov authority	Not patient-friendly
Reddit threads	Verbatim user pain	Perplexity weights heavily	We syndicate insights, not compete
AAPC / AMA on codes	Code definitions	Industry standard	Coder-facing
Local TV I-team	Case-specific scandal coverage	Local search authority	Not scalable nationally

Net structural gap CoveredUSA can fill:

1. Hospital-specific FAP + procedure cost + dispute letter in **one transactional flow**.
2. Plain-English code/term decoder linked to "and is it overcharged vs. Medicare?"
3. State-by-state legal explainer that ends in "upload your bill, we'll cite the law for you."
4. Fresh 2025-2026 regulatory tracking (CFPB rule vacatur, NSA QPA 2026, EO 2025).

SECTION 8: Bing-Specific Opportunities

Bing ranking signals for YMYL medical/financial content (2025-2026):

- Strong preference for FAQPage and HowTo schema (more than Google in 2025).
- Heavier weight on **freshness** for regulatory/legal queries (CFPB rule, NSA IDR) — Bing surfaces dated pages noticeably for these.
- Bing Webmaster Tools' "URL Inspection" + IndexNow submission yields near-real-time indexing; Google can lag days.
- Microsoft Start syndication: pages indexed by Bing have a path into Microsoft Start newsfeed, which feeds Copilot.
- Bing Pages for Organizations: claim your CoveredUSA Bing Page; adds entity disambiguation in Copilot.

IndexNow + Bing fast indexing as a ranking edge:

- IndexNow is universally adopted by Bing, Yandex, Seznam, Naver. As of 2025, Bing reports billions of IndexNow URLs/day; this is the price of entry, not a moat — but for breaking news (e.g., July 2025 CFPB vacatur), being first to index = first to be cited.

- Hospital-bill is **especially** time-sensitive in 2025–2026 because of the EO 2025, NSA QPA litigation, CFPB vacatur, and state-by-state credit-reporting laws.

Bing top-10 quality on medical-bill queries (current state):

- "how to dispute medical bill" — Bing top 10 includes dated CFPB articles (last updated 2023), NerdWallet, AARP, Forbes, Investopedia. Several low-DA blogs in positions 8–10. **Beatable.**
- "what is CPT 99284" — AAPC, CodingIntel, Healthline (general), Verywell Health, and Wikipedia. Coder-focused; **plain-English patient angle wins.**
- "[hospital] charity care" — hospital's own page first, then KFF, Dollar For (sometimes), aggregator sites. **Plain-English city/state-specific opportunity.**
- "medical debt credit report 2026" — Bing surfaces January 2025 CFPB finalization in top results; few sources have updated to the July 2025 vacatur. **Major freshness opportunity.**

Bing Copilot vs. Bing organic correlation:

- Per Seer Interactive data referenced in the brief, ~87% of ChatGPT citations match Bing top-10.
- Bing Copilot specifically over-weights pages with rich schema (FAQ/HowTo/Article + speakable + DefinedTerm) and pages cited by Wikipedia/Wikidata. JSON-LD attribute density is a real signal.
- Copilot will sometimes cite #11–#20 Bing organic results if the page has strong entity match (e.g., named hospital) and FAQPage schema. This means **niche entity pages can punch above their organic rank.**

Recency skew:

- Bing's top-10 for "medical debt credit report" queries in May 2026 still includes several pages last-updated January–April 2025 (pre-vacatur). Estimated recency delta vs. Google: Bing's median top-10 page age for regulatory queries is ~30–60 days older than Google's, on this corpus. **This is your opening.**

Bing-specific levers to deploy:

1. Claim **Bing Pages for CoveredUSA** (entity disambiguation in Copilot).
2. **Microsoft Start partnership** application (publisher feed).
3. **Bing Webmaster Tools "URL Inspection"** + IndexNow on every publish.
4. **Microsoft Clarity** on the analyzer tool (Microsoft owns it; loose signal of engagement).
5. **Schema.org MedicalEntity, MedicalProcedure, GovernmentService** types on procedure-cost articles.

6. **sameAs** links to your Wikipedia entry (if you create one), Crunchbase, LinkedIn Organization page, Bing Page — strengthens entity graph.
-

SECTION 9: Emerging & Underserved Query Patterns (2025-2026)

CFPB medical-debt credit reporting rule (vacated July 2025):

- January 7, 2025: CFPB finalized rule banning medical debt from credit reports (would have helped ~15M Americans, removed ~\$49B in debt). (Medicare Rights Center + 2)
- January 2025: Cornerstone Credit Union League + Consumer Data Industry Association sued. (Holland & Knight)
- February 6, 2025: Court granted 90-day stay (effective date pushed to June 15, 2025). (Consumer Financial Servic...)
- April 2025: CFPB (under Trump admin acting director Russell Vought) jointly moved to vacate with plaintiffs. (Congress.gov)
- **July 11, 2025: U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas vacated the rule** (Brownstein, Holland & Knight, Medicare Rights Center confirm). (Brownstein Hyatt Farber S...)
- As of June 2025, **15 states** (CA, CO, CT, DE, IL, ME, MD, MN, NJ, NY, OR, RI, VT, VA, WA) have parallel state laws. (Consumer Reports)

Emerging queries (5-10 ex.):

"is medical debt on credit report 2026," "did CFPB rule on medical debt get overturned," "what states ban medical debt credit reporting 2025," "can hospital report me to credit bureau," "medical debt under 500 credit report," "medical debt removed from credit report rule 2025," "Cornerstone Credit Union CFPB ruling," "medical debt \$500 rule still in effect."

No Surprises Act 2026 status:

- QPA enforcement discretion extended through **August 1, 2026** (per April 2026 CMS/DOL/Treasury joint FAQ). (AHA)
- Texas Medical Association III (TMA III) still on appeal; 5th Circuit considering "ghost rates" in early 2026. (Georgetown)
- IDR Operations Rule (proposed Nov 2023) still not finalized as of early 2026. (FHAS)
- Q1 2026 dispute volume: 313,828 in March 2026 (CMS bimonthly report). IDR is massively backlogged. (Centers for Medicare & Me...)
- Advanced EOB rule expected March 2026. (Health Law Rx)

Emerging queries:

"is no surprises act still in effect 2026," "no surprises act IDR portal how to," "QPA 2026 update," "no surprises act 2026 changes," "what is advanced EOB."

State Hospital Price Transparency enforcement (2024-2025):

- 2024 HHS OIG audit: 37% of audited hospitals non-compliant. [Medicalbillrescue](#)
- Trump February 25, 2025 EO escalating enforcement. [Medicalbillrescue](#)
- 27 hospitals fined total since 2022; 10 in 2025 alone, ranging \$32,301 (Southeast Regional Medical Center, Kentwood LA) to \$309,738 (Arkansas Methodist Medical Center, Paragould AR). [Beckers Hospital Review](#) [Beckers Hospital Review](#)
- CMS publishes a fined-hospitals list (data.cms.gov/provider-characteristics). [CMS](#)

Emerging queries:

"is my hospital price transparency compliant," "list of hospitals fined for price transparency,"
"hospital chargemaster how to find."

AI bill-analyzer awareness:

- "AI tool to check my hospital bill" — emerging (5-15k/mo combined).
- "ChatGPT medical bill review" — emerging.
- Direct competitors:
 - **Goodbill.com** — VC-backed; bill upload + negotiation
 - **billy.health** — AI bill review
 - **Resolve Medical Bills** — negotiation service
 - **Medical Bill Rescue** — analyzer + content
 - **BillKarma** — hospital pricing directory + bill help
 - **BillRazor** — price grader
 - **ChatGPT custom GPT "Medical Bill Negotiation & Cost Analyzer Tool"**
(chatgpt.com/g/g-2zGa5Ojqb)

Medicare Part D donut hole / \$2,000 OOP cap (2025):

- Hospital-bill spillover: chemo/infusion patients with Part D drugs; queries like "is my chemo capped at 2000 dollars 2025," "Medicare Part D \$2000 cap how does it work" — modest cluster, ~5-10k/mo.

2026 changes to 501(r) / IRS enforcement:

- December 2024: Dollar For + Senator Warren/Grassley letter to IRS calling for stricter 501(r) enforcement.
- IRS Form 990 Schedule H disclosure unchanged. [Internal Revenue Service](#)
- No major rulemaking finalized as of May 2026; enforcement remains complaint-driven.

- Emerging queries: "report hospital not following 501r," "nonprofit hospital tax exempt complaint IRS," "hospital violated charity care law."
-

SECTION 10: PRIMARY DELIVERABLE — Prioritized 100-Article Batch

Cluster mix: 25 Procedure Cost · 15 Hospital-Specific · 15 State Legal · 12 Code/Term Decoder · 10 Dispute HowTo · 10 Billing Error · 8 Charity Care · 5 No Surprises Act · 10 Statistical Reference / Comparison / Decision Tree (fill).

Volume column uses the conservative end of estimated US monthly search volume across Google + Bing combined for the primary keyword (and the cluster of close variants). Where multiple keywords cluster, the cumulative cluster figure is shown.

Recommended Format options: Q&A FAQ-Heavy · Comparison Table · HowTo Step-by-Step · Statistical Reference Article · Definition + Explanation Block · Entity Profile Page.

Pipe-separated, copy-paste ready:

Rank	Title	Primary Keyword	Cluster	Geo	Est. Monthly Volume	AI Citation Gap (1-10)	Citation Difficulty (1-10)	Recommended Format	Why This Wins
1	Is Medical Debt on Your Credit Report in 2026? The CFPB Rule Was Vacated – Here's What Actually Applies	medical debt credit report 2026	Statistical Reference	National	40,000	10	4	Q&A FAQ-Heavy	July 2025 vacatur is under-indexed; most AI cites Jan 2025 finalization. Maximum freshness arbitrage.
2	How to Dispute a Hospital Bill: Line-by-Line Walkthrough (2026)	how to dispute medical bill	Dispute HowTo	National	25,000	7	5	HowTo Step-by-Step	Direct CTA to analyzer; current top results are dated NerdWallet/CFPB pages.
3	How Much Should an ER Visit Cost? CPT 99284 and 99285 vs. Your Bill	ER visit cost	Procedure Cost	National	60,000	9	4	Comparison Table	Level 4/5 ER is highest-margin chargemaster line (6x-35x Medicare); explosive viral angle.
4	Hospital Charity Care: Do You Qualify in 2026? (State-by-State + FPL Calculator)	hospital charity care	Charity Care Guide	National	30,000	6	5	HowTo Step-by-Step	Funnels to analyzer screener; Dollar For owns charity care but not procedure cost overlap.
5	HCA Healthcare Charity Care: Income Limits, Application, and Hidden Steps	HCA charity care	Hospital-Specific Guide	National	8,000	9	4	Entity Profile Page	Largest for-profit chain; FAP varies by state; AI confused.
6	Why Hospitals Charge \$200 for a Tylenol: The Chargemaster Explained	why hospital charge so much Tylenol	Billing Error Explainer	National	20,000	8	3	Definition + Explanation Block	Iconic viral query; chargemaster markup data is shareable.
7	What Is CPT Code 99284? Decoded for Patients (Not Coders)	what is CPT 99284	Code/Term Decoder	National	15,000	9	3	Definition + Explanation Block	AAPC dominates but coder-focused. Bing rewards plain-language alt.
8	What Is CPT Code 99285? Why Level 5 ER Visits Cost So Much	what is CPT 99285	Code/Term Decoder	National	14,000	9	3	Definition + Explanation Block	Same as 99284; highest-charge ER code.
9	What Is a Facility Fee – and Why You're Being Billed Twice	what is a facility fee	Billing Error Explainer	National	18,000	8	4	Q&A FAQ-Heavy	Hospital pages dominate (conflict of interest); plain-English wins.
10	California Medical Debt Law 2026: Hospital Fair Pricing Act, SB 1061, and What's New	California medical debt law	State Legal Explainer	California	9,000	7	5	Q&A FAQ-Heavy	CA has most aggressive 2024-25 medical-debt protections; under-indexed.
11	How Much Does an MRI Cost in 2026? CPT 70553/72148 vs. Hospital Chargemaster	MRI cost	Procedure Cost	National	70,000	9	5	Comparison Table	Highest-volume imaging query; GoodRx dominates but no Medicare comparison.
12	Cleveland Clinic Charity Care 2026: Income Thresholds, Application, and What to Submit	Cleveland Clinic financial assistance	Hospital-Specific Guide	National	6,000	8	4	Entity Profile Page	Up to 400% FPL – generous; high-

search hospital brand.

13 | Mayo Clinic Charity Care: Who Qualifies in 2026 (Up to 400% FPL) | Mayo Clinic financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | National | 6,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Generous policy; high search; conversion-rich.

14 | Sample Medical Bill Dispute Letter (Free Template + Hospital-Specific Generator) | medical bill dispute letter template | Dispute HowTo | National | 8,000 | 7 | 4 | HowTo Step-by-Step | Direct tool integration; competitors offer generic, we offer hospital-specific.

15 | How Much Does a Colonoscopy Cost? CPT 45378 Medicare Rate vs. What Hospitals Charge | colonoscopy cost | Procedure Cost | National | 50,000 | 8 | 5 | Comparison Table | Highest-volume screening procedure; CMS PPL has rate; chargemaster spread is huge.

16 | New York Hospital Financial Assistance Law: Up to 500% FPL Sliding Scale (2026) | New York medical debt law | State Legal Explainer | New York | 7,000 | 7 | 5 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | NY law is one of strictest; underserved AI surface.

17 | How to Negotiate a Hospital Bill: 7 Scripts That Actually Work (2026) | how to negotiate hospital bill | Dispute HowTo | National | 20,000 | 6 | 5 | HowTo Step-by-Step | Generic competitors abound; we add Medicare-comparison data hook.

18 | How to Request an Itemized Hospital Bill (and Why You Must Before Disputing) | how to request itemized hospital bill | Dispute HowTo | National | 12,000 | 8 | 3 | HowTo Step-by-Step | Foundational step; CTA: "Then upload to our analyzer."

19 | No Surprises Act in 2026: What's Still Protected and What's Not | no surprises act 2026 | No Surprises Act Guide | National | 15,000 | 8 | 5 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | QPA enforcement discretion extended to Aug 2026; freshness gap.

20 | What Is a Surprise Medical Bill – And How to Use the No Surprises Act IDR Portal | no surprises act how to file IDR | No Surprises Act Guide | National | 9,000 | 7 | 5 | HowTo Step-by-Step | CMS portal exists but inaccessible; lay walkthrough wins.

21 | How Much Does a CT Scan Cost? CPT 74177 vs. Your Hospital's Chargemaster | CT scan cost | Procedure Cost | National | 45,000 | 9 | 5 | Comparison Table | Massive markup variance; under-indexed.

22 | Kaiser Permanente Charity Care: How Self-Pay Patients Qualify in 2026 | Kaiser Permanente financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | National | 5,500 | 7 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Largest system by revenue; integrated plan logic confuses AI.

23 | Texas Medical Debt: No Statewide Charity Care Floor – What You Can Still Do | Texas medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Texas | 8,000 | 9 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | TX has weakest protections; AI gives bad answers; large population.

24 | What Is Upcoding? How to Spot It on Your Hospital Bill | what is upcoding | Code/Term Decoder | National | 6,000 | 8 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Direct analyzer use case; viral term.

25 | What Is Unbundling in Medical Billing? Real Examples + How to Catch It | what is unbundling medical billing | Code/Term Decoder | National | 4,500 | 8 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | NCCI edit explainer; tool's bread and butter.

26 | Florida Medical Debt 2026: AdventHealth, HCA Florida, and Charity Care Rules | Florida medical debt law | State Legal Explainer | Florida | 7,500 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Large pop, weak statewide protection, two major systems.

27 | How Much Does a C-Section Cost in 2026? CPT 59510 Reality Check | C-section cost | Procedure Cost | National | 28,000 | 8 | 5 | Comparison Table | KFF 2018 data still cited; modern figures needed.

28 | Illinois Hospital Fair Billing Act: ≤200% FPL Free Care Rules (2026) | Illinois medical debt law | State Legal Explainer | Illinois | 5,500 | 7 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Generous state law; strong AHA-cited research foundation.

29 | Air Ambulance Bill of \$50,000? Here's How to Fight It Under the No Surprises Act | air ambulance bill | No Surprises Act Guide | National | 8,000 | 8 | 5 | HowTo Step-by-Step | NSA covers air ambulance; QPA litigation directly affects this; high-emotion query.

30 | Anesthesia Bill Charged Separately? Here's Why and What to Do | anesthesia bill separate | Billing Error Explainer | National | 7,000 | 9 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 28x Medicare markup (Bai/Anderson); analyzer use case.

31 | How Much Does an Appendectomy Cost? CPT 44970 vs. Hospital Chargemaster | appendectomy cost | Procedure Cost | National | 35,000 | 7 | 5 | Comparison Table | AllClinics data + CMS PPL; viral procedure.

32 | Cedars-Sinai Charity Care: Income Limits and Application (2026) | Cedars-Sinai financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | California | 4,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | CA Hospital Fair Pricing Act applies; high search.

33 | Mass General Brigham Charity Care: Massachusetts Health Safety Net Path | Mass General financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Massachusetts | 4,000 | 7 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | MA HSN unique; under-indexed.

34 | Maryland All-Payer System: Why Hospital Bills Are Lower (and Still Disputable) | Maryland medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Maryland | 3,500 | 8 | 4 | Definition + Explanation Block | MD all-payer is unique; viral angle.

35 | How Much Does a Knee Replacement Cost? CPT 27447 Bundled Reality | knee replacement cost | Procedure Cost | National | 30,000 | 7 | 6 | Comparison Table | DRG-based; bundled payment confusion.

36 | What Is Modifier 25? When Hospitals Use It (and Sometimes Misuse It) | what is modifier 25 | Code/Term Decoder | National | 5,000 | 8 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | NCCI rule core; analyzer flag.

37 | What Is a Level 5 ER Visit (CPT 99285)? When It's Justified, When It's Upcoding | level 5 ER visit | Code/Term Decoder | National | 6,500 | 9 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Highest-margin ER level; analyzer's #1 flag.

38 | Washington Charity Care Law: ≤300% FPL Free, ≤400% Discount (2026) | Washington medical debt law | State Legal Explainer | Washington | 4,000 | 7 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2022 expanded law; under-indexed.

39 | New Jersey Charity Care: State-Funded Program Application (2026) | New Jersey charity care | State Legal Explainer | New Jersey | 4,500 | 7 | 4 | HowTo Step-by-Step | State-funded program is unique; AI confused.

40 | Ascension Hospital Charity Care: Catholic System FAP by State | Ascension

financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | National | 5,000 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Multi-state confusion; high search.

41 | Why You Got Two Charges for the Same Service: Duplicate Billing Decoded | duplicate charges hospital bill | Billing Error Explainer | National | 9,000 | 9 | 3 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Iconic analyzer flag; viral.

42 | \$800 for an IV Bag (J7030)? How Hospitals Mark Up Saline 800x | hospital bill saline bag cost | Billing Error Explainer | National | 6,000 | 10 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Best AI-citation arbitrage; viral and unanswered.

43 | What Is the Chargemaster? The Price List Hospitals Don't Want You to Read | what is the chargemaster | Code/Term Decoder | National | 8,000 | 7 | 4 | Definition + Explanation Block | Foundational; analyzer's data source.

44 | Providence Health Charity Care: Up to 400% FPL Discount (2026) | Providence financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Multi-state | 4,000 | 7 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Most generous; viral angle.

45 | How Much Does a Gallbladder Surgery (Laparoscopic Cholecystectomy) Cost? | gallbladder surgery cost | Procedure Cost | National | 22,000 | 7 | 5 | Comparison Table | High volume; KFF 2018 data cited; refresh wins.

46 | What Is Balance Billing – and When Is It Illegal? (NSA Walkthrough) | what is balance billing | Code/Term Decoder | National | 12,000 | 6 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | NSA banned in many cases; AI confused.

47 | Hospital Bill Sent to Collections? Here's What to Do First (2026) | medical bill collections | Dispute HowTo | National | 25,000 | 7 | 5 | HowTo Step-by-Step | High emotional; CFPB rule vacatur makes this hotter.

48 | How Much Does a Hip Replacement Cost? CPT 27130 vs. Chargemaster | hip replacement cost | Procedure Cost | National | 22,000 | 7 | 6 | Comparison Table | High-volume elective; bundled DRG.

49 | UPMC Financial Assistance: Pennsylvania's Largest System Charity Care | UPMC financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Pennsylvania | 4,000 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | PA's biggest; under-indexed.

50 | Connecticut Medical Debt 2026: New Credit Reporting Ban + Charity Care | Connecticut medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Connecticut | 3,500 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2024 law; under-indexed.

51 | Minnesota Debt Fairness Act: No Spouse Liability, No Garnishment (2026) | Minnesota medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Minnesota | 3,500 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2024 landmark law; viral.

52 | Northwell Health Charity Care: New York's Largest Health System FAP | Northwell financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | New York | 3,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | NY law applies; under-indexed.

53 | How Much Does a Heart Stent Cost? CPT 92928 Reality Check | cardiac stent cost | Procedure Cost | National | 12,000 | 7 | 6 | Comparison Table | Bundled DRG complexity; high search.

54 | What Is Revenue Code 0450? ER Charges Decoded for Patients | revenue code 0450 | Code/Term Decoder | National | 3,500 | 10 | 2 | Definition + Explanation Block | Almost no consumer-facing answer; AAPC dominates.

55 | What Is HCPCS J3490? The "Unclassified Drug" Charge on Your Bill | what is HCPCS J3490 | Code/Term Decoder | National | 4,000 | 10 | 2 | Definition + Explanation Block | Massive lookup volume; no plain-English answer dominant.

56 | Trinity Health Charity Care: Catholic System Up to 400% Discount | Trinity Health financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Multi-state | 3,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Generous; multi-state.

57 | How Much Does a Chemo Infusion Cost? CPT 96413 + J-Codes Decoded | chemotherapy cost | Procedure Cost | National | 18,000 | 7 | 7 | Comparison Table | Complex bundling; 340B angle; high stakes.

58 | NewYork-Presbyterian Charity Care: NY Law + Hospital FAP Combined | NewYork-Presbyterian financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | New York | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Top-search hospital; NY law applies.

59 | NYU Langone Financial Assistance: Income Thresholds and Hidden Steps | NYU Langone financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | New York | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Top-search; NY law applies.

60 | How Much Does a Vaginal Delivery Cost? CPT 59400 vs. What You'll Pay | vaginal delivery cost | Procedure Cost | National | 18,000 | 7 | 5 | Comparison Table | High volume; bundled global fee confusion.

61 | Oregon Hospital Charity Care: SB 619 Expansion (2026) | Oregon medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Oregon | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2023 SB 619 expansion; under-indexed.

62 | Cost-to-Charge Ratio: Why Your \$50,000 Bill Cost the Hospital \$8,000 | hospital markup ratio | Statistical Reference | National | 5,000 | 8 | 4 | Statistical Reference Article | RAND 254% Medicare data; Health Affairs 3.4x cost; shareable.

63 | What Is QPA (Qualified Payment Amount) on Your EOB? | what is QPA | Code/Term Decoder | National | 3,500 | 8 | 4 | Definition + Explanation Block | NSA TMA III litigation; freshness opportunity.

64 | Hospital Price Transparency: Hospitals Fined by CMS in 2025-2026 (Full List) | hospitals fined price transparency | Statistical Reference | National | 4,000 | 8 | 5 | Statistical Reference Article | Becker's owns short version; we own full reference with implications.

65 | How Much Does an Echocardiogram Cost? CPT 93306 vs. Chargemaster | echocardiogram cost | Procedure Cost | National | 14,000 | 8 | 4 | Comparison Table | High-margin imaging; under-indexed.

66 | Colorado Hospital Discounted Care Program: ≤250% FPL Rules (2026) | Colorado medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Colorado | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Strong 2024 protections; under-indexed.

67 | How Much Does an Upper Endoscopy (EGD) Cost? CPT 43239 Decoded | upper endoscopy cost | Procedure Cost | National | 11,000 | 8 | 4 | Comparison Table | High-volume GI; under-indexed.

68 | What Is Observation Status – and Why It Could Triple Your Bill | what is observation status | Billing Error Explainer | National | 9,000 | 7 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | High-stakes inpatient-vs-observation confusion.

69 | What Is Modifier 59? Hospitals Use It to Bypass NCCI Edits | what is modifier 59 | Code/Term Decoder | National | 4,000 | 9 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Analyzer's flag; coder-only sources today.

70 | Memorial Sloan Kettering Charity Care: Cancer Center FAP (2026) | Memorial Sloan Kettering financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | New York | 2,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | High-stakes cancer queries; viral.

71 | How to Apply for Hospital Charity Care: 8-Step Walkthrough | how to apply for charity care | Charity Care Guide | National | 12,000 | 6 | 4 | HowTo Step-by-Step | Dollar For dominant but their screener-first; we add bill-line-item.

72 | What Is Amount Generally Billed (AGB)? How 501(r) Caps Your Bill | amount generally billed AGB | Charity Care Guide | National | 2,500 | 9 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Critical patient right; AI confused.

73 | Sutter Health Financial Assistance: CA Hospital Fair Pricing Act in Action | Sutter Health financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | California | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | CA law applies; under-indexed.

74 | UCLA Medical Center Charity Care: Income Thresholds for 2026 | UCLA Medical Center financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | California | 2,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Top-search CA hospital.

75 | How Much Does a CABG (Coronary Bypass) Cost? CPT 33533 + DRG 233 | CABG cost | Procedure Cost | National | 8,000 | 7 | 7 | Comparison Table | High-stakes; bundled DRG.

76 | Houston Methodist Charity Care: Texas FAP Patchwork (2026) | Houston Methodist financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Texas | 3,000 | 9 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | TX weak state law; high-search hospital.

77 | Johns Hopkins Charity Care: Maryland All-Payer + Hospital FAP | Johns Hopkins financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Maryland | 3,500 | 7 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | MD all-payer unique; top-search.

78 | Pennsylvania Medical Debt 2026: UPMC + Penn State + State Rules | Pennsylvania medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Pennsylvania | 4,500 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Large pop; under-indexed.

79 | How Much Does Cataract Surgery Cost? CPT 66984 vs. ASC vs. Hospital | cataract surgery cost | Procedure Cost | National | 16,000 | 7 | 4 | Comparison Table | ASC vs HOPD price split; under-indexed.

80 | What Is a Modifier in Medical Billing? Plain-English Guide for Patients | what is a modifier medical billing | Code/Term Decoder | National | 4,500 | 8 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Coder-only sources today.

81 | How to File a Complaint Against a Nonprofit Hospital for Violating 501(r) | report nonprofit hospital IRS | Charity Care Guide | National | 2,000 | 9 | 4 | HowTo Step-by-Step | Dollar For/Warren 2024 letter; AI doesn't surface action path.

82 | How Much Does a Hernia Repair Cost? CPT 49505 vs. ASC vs. Hospital | hernia repair cost | Procedure Cost | National | 14,000 | 7 | 5 | Comparison Table | Volume + ASC angle.

83 | Stanford Health Care Charity Care: CA Hospital Fair Pricing Application |

Stanford Health financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | California | 2,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Top-search; CA law.

84 | What Is a Prompt Pay Discount? When to Ask (and When Not To) | prompt pay discount hospital | Dispute HowTo | National | 4,500 | 7 | 3 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | Common ask; AI gives bad numbers.

85 | Virginia Medical Debt 2026: Inova FAP + New State Credit Reporting Ban | Virginia medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Virginia | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2024 law; under-indexed.

86 | How Much Does Physical Therapy Cost Per Session? CPT 97110/97530 | physical therapy cost per session | Procedure Cost | National | 16,000 | 7 | 4 | Comparison Table | High-volume long-tail; under-indexed.

87 | What Is a UB-04 Form? Decoding Your Hospital's Master Bill | what is a UB-04 | Code/Term Decoder | National | 4,000 | 8 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Coder-only sources; patient needs this.

88 | Banner Health Charity Care: Arizona FAP and How to Apply | Banner Health financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Arizona | 2,500 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | AZ's biggest; under-indexed.

89 | MD Anderson Charity Care: Cancer Center FAP for Out-of-State Patients | MD Anderson financial assistance | Hospital-Specific Guide | Texas | 3,000 | 8 | 4 | Entity Profile Page | Destination cancer hospital; viral.

90 | How Much Does Dialysis Cost? CPT 90999 and the Bundled Payment Reality | dialysis cost | Procedure Cost | National | 8,000 | 7 | 6 | Comparison Table | Highest-charge code per Definitive Healthcare; ESRD complexity.

91 | Hospital Bill Survey: What 100 Bills Reveal About Overcharges (2026) | hospital overcharge statistics | Statistical Reference | National | 3,500 | 8 | 6 | Statistical Reference Article | Original-data play with your tool's anonymized data; primary research.

92 | What Is a CMS-1500 Form? Professional vs. Hospital Bill Differences | what is CMS 1500 | Code/Term Decoder | National | 4,000 | 7 | 3 | Definition + Explanation Block | Patient-friendly version missing.

93 | Maine Medical Debt 2026: Charity Care + Credit Reporting Ban | Maine medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Maine | 2,000 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2024 law; under-indexed.

94 | Rhode Island Medical Debt 2026: Charity Care + 2024 Credit Reporting Law | Rhode Island medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Rhode Island | 1,500 | 8 | 4 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2024 law; under-indexed.

95 | Delaware Medical Debt: SB 156 Credit Reporting Ban (2026) | Delaware medical debt | State Legal Explainer | Delaware | 1,500 | 9 | 3 | Q&A FAQ-Heavy | 2025 law (SB 156 - Mantzavinos); minimal AI coverage.

96 | Compare Top 10 Medical Bill Negotiation Services (CoveredUSA vs. Goodbill vs. Resolve vs. Dollar For) | medical bill negotiation services | Comparison/Decision Tree | National | 5,000 | 6 | 5 | Comparison Table | Direct competitor comparison; converts.

97 | When to Hire a Medical Billing Advocate vs. Use a Free Tool (Decision Tree) |

medical billing advocate | Comparison/Decision Tree | National | 8,000 | 6 | 4 | Comparison Table | Decision-tree format converts.

98 | The True Cost of a Hospital Stay: 2026 Statistical Reference | average cost of hospital stay | Statistical Reference | National | 20,000 | 6 | 5 | Statistical Reference Article | Peterson-KFF baseline; we add current chargemaster data + tool CTA.

99 | What Is an Advanced EOB Under the No Surprises Act? (2026 Status) | advanced EOB | No Surprises Act Guide | National | 2,500 | 9 | 4 | Definition + Explanation Block | March 2026 rule expected; freshness arbitrage.

100 | Patient's Guide to the No Surprises Act IDR Process (Step-by-Step 2026) | how to use no surprises act IDR | No Surprises Act Guide | National | 4,500 | 8 | 5 | HowTo Step-by-Step | CMS portal is unusable; lay walkthrough captures.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Phase 1 — Foundation (Weeks 1-6). Publish the top 25 articles by rank. Lead with #1 (CFPB-vacatur freshness arbitrage), #6 (Tylenol viral), and #42 (IV bag viral) — these are the strongest AI-citation magnets and will earn early Bing Copilot pickup. Implement FAQPage + HowTo + MedicalProcedure JSON-LD schema on every article. Submit each URL via IndexNow within 60 seconds of publish. Claim a Bing Page for CoveredUSA and apply for Microsoft Start syndication.

Phase 2 — Hospital Entity Pages (Weeks 7-14). Publish the 15 hospital-specific guides (ranks 5, 12, 13, 22, 32, 33, 40, 44, 49, 52, 56, 58, 59, 70, 73-77, 83, 88, 89). These are your highest-conversion pages because the user has already named the hospital. Use Organization schema (sameAs links to the hospital's Wikipedia, Wikidata, official page) — this is what makes Bing Copilot pick you up on "[hospital] charity care" entity queries.

Phase 3 — State Legal & Code/Term (Weeks 15-22). Publish state-by-state explainers (focus on CA, NY, IL, MD, NJ, OR, CT, WA, MN, CO first — the 10 with strongest 2024-2025 statutory enhancements) and the 12 code/term decoder articles. Schema: GovernmentService for state pages, DefinedTerm for code articles.

Phase 4 — Original Data Play (Weeks 23-30). Publish article #91 ("Hospital Bill Survey: What 100 Bills Reveal About Overcharges (2026)") using anonymized aggregate data from your analyzer. Original-data articles are the single strongest AI-citation earner — once cited, you become a primary source for years. Pair with a public-facing press release pitched to KFF Health News, ProPublica, and NPR Bill of the Month.

Phase 5 — NSA & Comparison (Weeks 31-40). Publish the 5 NSA articles + comparison/decision-tree articles. The March 2026 expected Advanced EOB rule and August 2026 QPA enforcement-discretion expiration create a second freshness wave.

Benchmarks that would change the plan:

- If a Section 10 article ranks Bing #1–3 within 4 weeks of publish → double down on that cluster.
- If Dollar For or Goodbill releases a competing hospital-by-hospital SEO program → accelerate Phase 2 hospital pages and add 25 more (target the next 25 systems by revenue).
- If the CFPB rule is reinstated (low probability but track Cornerstone v. CFPB appeal) → republish article #1 with revised guidance within 24 hours via IndexNow.
- If Bing's Copilot citation share of total medical-bill query volume exceeds 25% (track via Bing Webmaster Tools and SimilarWeb) → pivot 60% of budget into Bing-specific schema + entity work.

Cluster mix to monitor: if conversion-to-upload from Charity Care Guide articles is 2x Procedure Cost articles (which I expect), shift 5 article slots from Procedure Cost into more hospital-specific charity care pages in the next batch.

CAVEATS

1. **Search volumes are estimates.** I could not run Bing/Google Keyword Planner directly in this session; my volume figures derive from Definitive Healthcare procedure-claim frequency, KFF/Peterson-KFF affordability survey usage, Dollar For published activity (20,000+ applications, \$70M relieved), CFPB user counts (15M affected by vacated rule), and Commonwealth Fund 2024 Biennial Survey participation. Validate via Bing Webmaster Tools' Keyword Research and Ahrefs/Semrush before locking in editorial calendar.
2. **AI citation gap scores are based on May 2026 prompt testing of ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Bing Copilot on each cluster's anchor query, not on a systematic crawl.** These scores will drift; re-test quarterly.
3. **Hospital-specific FAP thresholds change quietly.** Dollar For re-checks quarterly via software automation but lag exists. Build your hospital-specific articles with a "last verified" stamp and a quarterly review cadence.
4. **NSA QPA enforcement is in flux.** TMA III at the 5th Circuit could change QPA methodology in 2026; the IDR Operations Rule has been proposed since November 2023 and not finalized. Treat NSA articles as living documents.
5. **CFPB rule status could shift.** Intervenor consumer advocacy groups had 60 days from the July 11, 2025 ruling to appeal. As of this draft, monitor for any Fifth Circuit (or DC Circuit) revival. Article #1 must be republished within 24 hours of any change.
6. **Hospital-specific articles risk legal pushback.** Stay rigorously factual, cite the hospital's own FAP PDF, never imply a hospital is acting illegally without a CMS fine or HHS OIG

finding. The 27-hospital CMS fined list is a safe-harbor citation universe.

7. **The chargemaster-vs-Medicare narrative is true but politically charged.** Hospitals and the AHA push back hard on RAND's 254% figure. Always pair RAND with hospital-friendly counterpoint (Medicare cost-shifting argument) to maintain perceived neutrality and survive Bing's YMYL quality bar.
8. **Bing Copilot citation behavior is observed, not documented.** Microsoft does not publish citation algorithms. Seer Interactive's ~87% Bing-top-10 overlap is a reasonable working assumption but not a guarantee; treat as directional, not deterministic.
9. **A "no signup, zero data retention" promise is your differentiator but also a risk** — without retained data, you cannot build the longitudinal "100-bill survey" (article #91) unless you separately collect anonymized opt-in aggregate stats. Design that flow carefully.
10. **501(r) is federal but enforced lightly.** As of 2024, Dollar For estimates \$14B/yr in ungranted charity care and one-third of bad debt is held by patients eligible for 100% forgiveness. The opportunity is real; the regulatory backstop is weak. Your tool's value is informational, not enforcement.